

Spraying insecticide such as DDT whether indoors or outside, has been—and in some places still is—a common method of controlling the mosquitoes that transmit malaria.

The chemical future

Silent Spring's impact needs to be seen against the backdrop of the time in which it was published. Although academics and scientists had already voiced concerns about synthetic pesticides, the public was oblivious to this issue.

Synthesized pesticides had been in use since the 1920s but had advanced significantly during World War II, powered by military-funded research.